

Marius Akaninyene Utong

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Profile

I have overall 17 years' experience in Infrastructure Management, with over 9 years of expertise in **DevOps Engineer /Cloud Engineer**, I excel in ensuring the reliability, availability, and peak performance of complex, large-scale systems. My broad skill set includes rigorous testing practices, in-depth knowledge of AWS, GCP and Azure, and proficiency in Infrastructure as Code (IaC) using Terraform and Helm for Kubernetes orchestration. I specialize in observability tools like AWS CloudWatch, Azure Monitor, GCP Monitor, Grafana, and Prometheus for meticulous system monitoring. Proficient in Helm, I streamline infrastructure management, leveraging automation with Ansible, Bash, and Python.

As a Cloud Engineer/DevOps Engineer I designs, implements, manages, and maintains cloud infrastructure, services, and solutions, ensuring efficient data storage and adherence to security policies, often working with cloud platforms like AWS, Azure, or GCP

With a talent for problem-solving and exceptional communication, I'm poised to excel and ensuring top-notch system performance and resilience.

Experience

Lead DevOps / Cloud Engineer | Microsoft VIA TEKNowledge Nigeria

November 2021 – January 2025

- Design, implement, and manage continuous integration (CI) and continuous deployment (CD) pipelines using Azure DevOps,AWS and GCP
- Automate the build, test, and deployment processes to improve development efficiency.
- Administer source code repositories using version control systems such as Git within Azure DevOps, AWS and GCP.
- Implement branching strategies and enforce code review processes.
- Configure and manage build pipelines to compile, build, and package applications.
- Automate the deployment of applications to various environments, including development, testing, and production.

- Implement Infrastructure as Code (IaC) practices using tools like Terraform for consistent and repeatable infrastructure deployment.
- Manage configuration settings for different environments and ensure consistency between development, testing, and production environments.
- Collaborate with development teams to understand their requirements and integrate CI/CD practices into the development workflow.
- Integrate automated testing processes into the CI/CD pipeline to ensure code quality and identify issues early in the development cycle.
- Integrate monitoring and logging tools into the CI/CD pipeline to capture and analyze application and deployment metrics.
- Implement security practices within the CI/CD pipeline, including static code analysis and vulnerability scanning.
- Ensure that security measures are integrated into the deployment process.
- Design, deploy, and manage Kubernetes clusters on Azure using Azure Kubernetes Service (AKS), EKS, GKE.
- Ensure high availability, scalability, and reliability of Kubernetes clusters.
- Manage containerized applications using Kubernetes orchestration features.
- Define and deploy pod specifications, replication controllers, services, and other Kubernetes objects.
- Implement and optimize CI/CD pipelines for deploying containerized applications to Kubernetes clusters.
- Set up monitoring solutions like AWS CloudWatch, Azure Monitor, GCP Monitor, Grafana, and Prometheus for tracking the performance and health of Kubernetes clusters.
- Configure and manage networking components within Kubernetes, such as services, ingress, and network policies.
- Integrate Kubernetes clusters with other Azure services, such as Azure Active Directory, Azure Container Registry and AWS Container Registry, Azure and AWS Storage.
- Design, implement, and manage Azure, AWS, GCP infrastructure solutions, ensuring scalability, reliability, and high availability.

- Create and maintain virtual machines, storage accounts, and networking components in Azure, AWS and GCP.
- Manage and version artifacts generated during the build process using Azure, AWS, GCP Artifacts or similar tools.
- Maintain documentation for CI/CD processes, including pipeline configurations, deployment procedures, and troubleshooting guides.
- Coordinate and manage release schedules in collaboration with development, testing, and operations teams.
- Implement and manage release gates to ensure the quality of deployments.
- Continuously evaluate and enhance CI/CD processes for efficiency and reliability.
- Implementing DevSecOps best practice:
 - Vulnerabilities - CVE, CVSS, NVD
 - Git hooks - Talisman
 - Testing : Mutation, Integration
 - Scans: Dependency checks, Trivy (images), OPA Conftest(Docker file), Kubesec(K8)
 - SAST: SonarQube, Microfocus Fortify
 - DAST: OWASP ZAP-Web Application
 - Deploy to K8 Namespaces: Deployment , Rollout Status
 - Kubernetes Security : CIS Benchmarking, Testing , Limits
 - ISTIO Service Mesh: Installation, Kiali, MTLS, Metrics
 - Monitoring: Kube-Scan, Falco, Falco UI, Falco Slack, GCP Monitor, Grafana, and Prometheus
 - Helm
 - Basic Notification: SLACK, Email, Legacy App Notification

Escalation Cloud Engineer | Microsoft VIA TEKNowledge Nigeria

June 2020 – November 2021

- Responsible for installing and maintaining the Linux server Distributions operating systems and various Linux applications and services such as Apache, TomCat, Kerberos, LDAP, MySQL, Pacemaker, Bash, Python, Ansible.
- Responsible for supporting setting up shared storage.
- Engages in high level complex problem-solving solutions across multiple infrastructures; feedback methods to Product Team

- Consistently delivers high excellent experiences to customers.
- Brings internally escalated customer cases to resolution through advanced high-level problem solving, assertive communication and collaboration.
- Proactively and consistently mentorship program for support engineers: active coaching.
- Coordinating support tasks and tickets management: ICM, Pg Escalations.
- Acts as a 1st point of contact for escalations
- Work with Team managers reinforcing process adherence and compliance.
- Aids new engineer during their nesting period.
- Closely overviewing team's performance and to promotes growth in the team's technical capabilities and enhances high level quality of support and boosts overall team's productivity.
- Helps identify difficult topics and knowledge gaps on the team.
- Constantly provide managers feedback about team's performance and be
- Evaluate systems and upgrades for appropriateness.
- Assist in the design, implementation, and maintenance of complex solutions.
- Coordinate activities with other technical personnel as appropriate.
- Develop and analyze complex system standards, thresholds, and recommendations to maximize system performance.
- Responsible for maintaining all server-side Security Certificates to ensure compliance with the cyber security policy.
- Develop Document strategies to manage the frequency of installations of the support package releases and patch.

Cloud Support Engineer | Microsoft VIA TEKNowledge Nigeria

June 2019 – May 2020

- Microsoft Azure, AWS, GCP: Storage, Virtual Machine Scaleset, Fileshare, Virtual Machine Deployment, Sql, Encryption, Azure Active Directory Domain Services
- Linux (Redhat, Centos,Ubuntu,Suse): Storage, Virtual Machine Scaleset, Fileshare, Virtual Machine Deployment, Sql, Encryption, Azure Active Directory Domain Services

- Act as the advanced technical contact for troubleshooting customer issues
- Deliver advanced technical troubleshooting and problem-solving solutions for corporate customers including issues escalated to the highest level of management
- Collaborate with domain experts (SMEs) and escalation managers when additional support is needed
- Manage critical issues by setting customer expectations, devise and implement action plans and professionally communicate measures to all parties involved
- Seek supplemental training to improve performance and develop a specialization Strength
- Strong research, problem-solving and troubleshooting skills
- Ability to work well independently and as part of a team
- Excellent customer service skills
- Responsible for the security posture and implementing patches of Linux assets during weekly maintenance windows (off-hours).
- Monitor system maintenance and provide technical recommendations for enhancement.
- Thorough understanding and workings of Server protocols including, NTP, SMTP, SFTP.
- Provide technical know-how to internal and external personnel on highly complex system administration and installation processes.
- Share knowledge and provide guidance to less experienced personnel.
- Thorough understanding and workings of incident handling protocols, personally identifiable information, Server network procedures, and information handling.
- Provide immediate response to break-fix
- As a customer-facing support engineer, my role is providing phone and email-based technical support to corporate customers while ensuring ticket resolution and customer satisfaction

DevOps Engineer | Drilex System Nigeria Ltd

November 2016 – May 2019

- Proactively maintain and develop all Linux infrastructure technology to maintain a 24x7x365 uptime service
- Enhance client's application performance by successful migration of a monolithic to Micro-Service architecture running on a large-scale AKS cluster.
- Established strong standards and processes around DevOps. automation and deployment for all
- Demonstrated leadership qualities as the primary contact and technical leader with the clients I worked with, leading the technical direction and conversation of each project I was assigned to.
- Achieved over 50% improvement in deployment time by optimizing container docker images and using smaller images (alpine), base images, and multi stage Dockerfiles.
- Enhanced security of all pipelines by integrating DevSecOps practices and tools into pipelines for every project I worked on.
- Observability as a code, using terraform to create Datadog dashboards and alerts to monitored channels.
- Develop automation for incident response.
- Assess the production readiness of services.
- Define and track operational metrics for production performance, reliability, scalability and availability.
- Architect, develop and maintain shared services and tools to improve reliability and reduce toil across the organization.
- Conducted discovery sessions to analyze the existing state of client environments and create reports to suggest solutions to issues found.
- Created CI/CD pipelines using Azure DevOps for large-scale environment deployment.
- Managed large scale customer Cloud infrastructure and deployment of our application for global multinationals clients.
- Improved infrastructure deployment time by over 50% by using Infrastructure as Code tools such as terraform and cloud formation.

- Delivered the infrastructure using the Azure Kubernetes services to host a containerized version of our application while ensuring a highly available and fault-tolerant environment.

Systems Administrator | Scotexs Systems Nigeria Ltd.

January 2008 – October 2016

- Proactively maintain and develop all Linux infrastructure technology to maintain a 24x7x365 uptime service
- Engineering of systems administration-related solutions for various project and operational needs
- Maintain best practices on managing systems and services across all environments
- Fault finding, analysis and logging information for reporting of performance exceptions
- Proactively monitoring system performance and capacity planning
- Manage, coordinate, and implement software upgrades, patches, hot fixes on servers, workstations, and network hardware
- Create and modify scripts or applications to perform tasks
- Provide input on ways to improve the stability, security, efficiency, and scalability of the environment
- Collaborate with other teams and team members to develop automation strategies and deployment processes
- In depth knowledge of Linux: RedHat, CentOS, Debian, etc.
- Hands on experience with MySQL and/or MariaDB
- Familiarity with VMWare and SAN management and concepts
- Expert in Shell, Perl, and/or Python scripting
- Solid knowledge of protocols such as DNS, HTTP, LDAP, SMTP and SNMP
- Strong problem solving and communication skills

- Configured systems for TCP/IP Networking with the existing Local Area Network. Set up SSH and SCP features on UNIX hosts.
- Coordinated with customers to develop ITIL process strategies for design.
- Monitored mapping of customer issues and developed appropriate solutions.
- Troubleshoot production servers to resolve issues related to web applications, Sendmail, disk space, file system, DNS and network connectivity.
- Hands on experience in physical to virtual machine conversions and virtual machines
- Worked with Enterprise Security Manager to get Security certification for servers before moving them in to production.
- Developed Cronjobs and Shell Scripts for automating administration tasks like file system management, process management, Server reboots etc.
- Installed and configured Redhat Server, Upgraded, patched, and installed Linux operating systems.
- Worked with EMC SAN to acquire storage and to set up Veritas/LVM file systems.
- Worked with Oracle DBAs to restore Oracle Instance and Build Oracle RAC Cluster.
- Worked on creating Virtual machines using VMware.
- Monitored system performance and Kernel tuning to enhance system performance.
- Provided 24/7 on-call support on a weekly basis.
- Worked with Enterprise Security Manager to get security certification for servers before moving them to production.
- Installed and configured domain wide mail systems utilizing Postfix with multi subnet and a single relay host for internal mail forwarding, all external mails were handled by Sendmail and SMTP.
- Performed post build activities like setting up, backup interface/NIC bonding/LACP Bonding/Loading additional Packages/ Joining the server to Active Directory.

Education

Certifications

- Microsoft Certified Trainer, Credential ID 3877627
- Microsoft Certified: Azure Administrator Associate, Credential ID: H801-2168
- AWS Administrator Certifications
- LFCS: Linux Foundation Certified Systems Administrator, Credential ID LF-g11nzipwkh.
- Microsoft Azure Linux Specialist (AZLS)
- Microsoft Azure Linux Foundation (AZLF)
- IT Infrastructure Library

Skills & Abilities

- DevOps: Azure DevOps, AWS, GCP, Argo CD, Git, Docker, Kubernetes
- Cloud Technologies: Azure, AWS, GCP
- Operating Systems: Linux (Ubuntu, CentOS, SUSE, Redhat) and Windows Server
- Scripting: PowerShell, Bash
- Infrastructure as Code: Terraform, Ansible, ARM Templates
- Monitoring and Logging: Azure Monitor, AWS Cloud Watch, Prometheus, Grafana.
- Networking: Azure, AWS, GCP Virtual Network, VPN, ExpressRoute
- Security: Azure Security Center, IAM, SSL/TLS
- Databases: Azure SQL Database, MySQL, HBase
- Control Systems: Git, GitHub, Azure Git
- CI/CD Pipelines: Azure DevOps, AWS, GCP, GitHub, Travis-CI, Jenkins
- Scripting Language: Python, JSON, YAML, Bash, XML, CLI and Shell scripting.
- Docker: Docker-files, Docker-Compose, Kubernetes and working with Docker containers, Splunk,
- Management Tools: Terraform, ARM, Ansible and continuous learning on AWS CloudFormation, Splunk

- IIS Management: Windows, Linux VMware and UNIX platforms
- Distributed Computing; Three- tier architecture, Client-Server architecture, Peer to Peer architecture, N-tier architecture.